



Western diamondback rattlesnake

One of the largest venomous snakes found in North America, this rattlesnake hunts desert rodents, but is also responsible for many human injuries in the US.



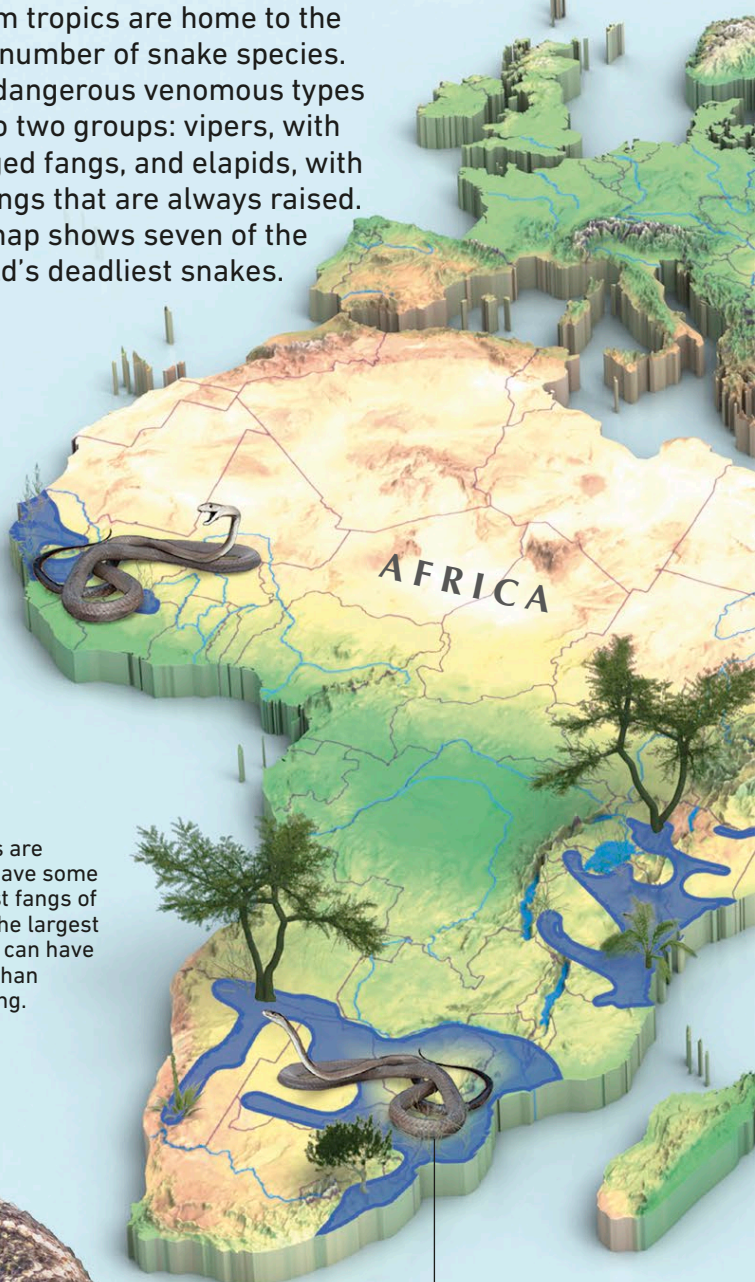
Common lance head

A relative of the rattlesnakes, the common lance head moves about at night, and is one of the most dangerous vipers found in the tropical forests of South America.

Deadly snakes

The warm tropics are home to the greatest number of snake species. The most dangerous venomous types belong to two groups: vipers, with large, hinged fangs, and elapids, with shorter fangs that are always raised.

This map shows seven of the world's deadliest snakes.



Black mamba

Named for the black lining of its mouth, this elapid is one of the longest and fastest of the venomous snakes in Africa and quickly inflicts multiple dangerous bites.

Fangs

Rattlesnakes are vipers, and have some of the biggest fangs of any snake. The largest rattlesnakes can have fangs more than 2 in (5 cm) long.

Warning rattle

The tail tip rattle is made up of special scales that produce a warning sound when shaken if predators come too close.



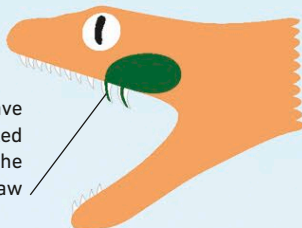
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Snake venom

Venom is a poisonous fluid that flows from glands in the snake's upper jaw. When the snake bites, a muscle squeezes venom out through the fangs. Viper fangs reach further forward than those of elapids.

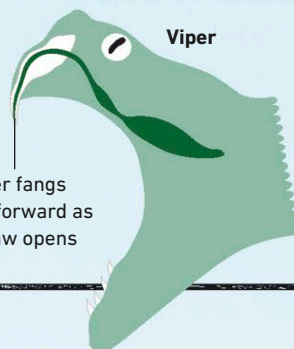
Elapid

Elapids have small, fixed fangs at the back of the jaw



Viper

Viper fangs swing forward as the jaw opens



KEY

- Western diamondback rattlesnake
- Common lance head
- Black mamba
- Saw-scaled viper
- Indian cobra
- Many-banded krait
- Tiger snake